AI Tool Selection Guide for Engineering Work

Choose the right tool for each task type

Chat Interfaces (Claude.ai, ChatGPT, Gemini)

General Q&A
Drafting documents
Explaining concepts
Brainstorming

Flexible, conversational
Good for exploration
Easy to iterate

NotebookLM (Google)

Research synthesis
Source−grounded answers
Podcast generation
Multi−document analysis

Cites sources directly
Reduces hallucination
Great for learning

Claude Code (CLI Tool)

Code development
File operations
Project automation
Technical implementation

Edits real files
Runs commands
Project−aware context

Browser Extensions (Claude, etc.)

Web page analysis
Quick questions
Content summarization
In−context assistance

Works in browser
No context switching
Immediate access